

BHRDCA Heritage – April 2025

Premiership Count

This article has been produced with acknowledgement to the efforts of past BHRDCA Committee members – who completed the initial research into the BHRDCA premiership records and to BHRDCA Life Members: Mike Dwyer and John Toogood – who put the list of premiers into categories and a format that could be easily recorded.

NOTE: These records include the 2024-25 premiership winners

Since its formation in 1890-91, the BHRDCA has celebrated **129** completed seasons.

Top Grade Premierships

The Top Grade is that recognized as the highest level of cricket played in the association during any given season. Since 1890-91, the top level has had seven names with the current title; McIntosh Shield – introduced in 1977-78 in recognition of the long service of Ray McIntosh as a player from 1922 to the mid 1950's (along with an additional 10 years in West Gippsland) and as Association Secretary from 1953-54 to 1976-77 (except 1960-61 when Jack Lennox acted in the Secretary's role).

BELOW IDENTIFIES THE NAME OF THE HIGHEST GRADE IN REPORTER CRICKET

Reporter	1890-91
Gilmore Shield	1891-92
Eastern District Trophy	1892-93
Eastern District Trophy	1898-99 to 1900-01
A Grade	1902-03 to 1968-69
A1 Grade	1969-70 to 1972-73
Reporter Shield	1973-74 to 1976-77
McIntosh Shield	1977-78 to 2013-14
Ray McIntosh Shield	2014-15 to current

- ❖ No competition 1893-94 to 1897-98 inclusive
- ❖ No competition 1901-02
- ❖ A Grade played for the Standard Shield (1920-21 to 1924-25), the Kent Shield (1925-26 to 1934-35) and the Nutting & Young Shield (1935-36 to WWII). The club that was first to win three premierships would keep the shield. This practice appears to have ceased at the start of WWII. Canterbury holds both the Standard and Kent Shield while the whereabouts of the Nutting & Young Shield, held by the Box Hill Church of Christ after their third flag in 1940-41 is unknown.
- ❖ There is reference to A Grade playing for the Bristco Plastic Shield in 1963-64
- ❖ The association changed its name from the Reporter District Cricket Association to the Box Hill Reporter District Cricket Association (BHRDCA) prior to the start of the 1933-34 season.

BELOW IDENTIFIES HOW PREMIERSHIPS WERE DECIDED EACH SEASON

Ladder Position	1890-91 to 1891-92; 1898-99 to 1900-01; 1903-04 to 1906-07; 1910-11 to 1912-13; 1914-15 to 1915-16; 1919-20
Grand Finals	1892-93; 1902-03; 1907-08 to 1909-10; 1913-14; 1916-17 to 1918-19; 1920-21 to present day

- ❖ In some seasons, fourteen two-day rounds were played that finished in late April. In 1919-20, most teams abandoned the competition after round twelve when it became obvious that Ringwood had won the premiership. The association decided that all premierships would be decided by a final from then on.

TOP GRADE PREMIERSHIP WINNERS

Titles	Club	Seasons
13	Mitcham	1905-06; 1909-10; 1910-11; 1946-47; 1947-48; 1949-50; 1950-51; 1954-55; 1956-57; 1975-76; 1986-87; 1991-92; 1997-98
12	Canterbury	1898-99; 1899-00; 1908-09; 1916-17; 1921-22; 1923-24; 1924-25; 1927-28; 1931-32; 1934-35; 1935-36; 1937-38
11	Nunawading	1957-58; 1958-59; 1960-61; 1965-66; 1966-67; 1968-69; 1973-74; 1976-77; 1979-80; 1981-82; 1983-84
11	Blackburn	1932-33; 1959-60; 1961-62; 1962-63; 1964-65; 1969-70; 1993-94; 1996-97; 2003-04; 2014-15; 2024-25
10	East Burwood	1944-45; 1945-46; 1948-49; 1951-52; 1952-53; 1953-54; 1967-68; 1974-75; 2016-17; 2020-21
9	Heatherdale	1982-83; 1985-86; 1987-88; 1992-93; 2002-03; 2009-10; 2012-13; 2015-16; 2021-22
7	Vermont	1942-43; 1970-71; 1998-99; 1999-00; 2000-01; 2001-02; 2006-07
6	Box Hill	1890-91; 1892-93; 1903-04 (Shared); 1922-23; 1925-26; 1926-27
6	Surrey Hills	1902-03; 1904-05; 1912-13; 1913-14; 1929-30; 1930-31
6	Forest Hill	1972-73; 1977-78; 2013-14; 2017-18; 2018-19; 2019-20
4	Templestowe	1911-12; 1918-19; 1928-29; 1984-85
4	East Box Hill	1995-96; 2005-06; 2007-08; 2010-11
4	Box Hill North Super Kings	1980-81; 1994-95; 2022-23; 2023-24
3	Box Hill Church of Christ	1938-39; 1939-40; 1940-41
3	Ringwood	1914-15; 1915-16; 1919-20
2	Doncaster	1917-18; 1920-21
2	Box Hill Methodists	1941-42; 1943-44
2	Doncaster Footballers	1955-56; 1971-72
2	Bennettswood	1988-89; 1990-91
2	Eley Park	1989-90; 2004-05
2	Bulleen Templestowe	2008-09; 2011-12

The following have won one premiership: -

Burwood (1891-92); Kew (1900-01); Old Mitcham (1903-04 shared); Doncaster Heights (1906-07); Camberwell (1907-08); St. Andrews (1933-34); East Doncaster (1936-37); Bulleen (1963-64); St.Davids (1978-79)

Notes:-

- ✚ Kew (1900-01) won a premiership in its only complete season in the Reporter Association
- ✚ Old Mitcham and Box Hill shared the 1903-04 premiership after finishing ~~on~~ equal on points on the ladder. By late April 1904, the competition had run out of time to play a deciding match with the association determined not to let this situation occur again.
- ✚ Vermont is the only club to win four successive premierships from 1998-99 to 2001-02
- ✚ Box Hill Church of Christ (1938-39; 1939-40 & 1940-41); East Burwood (1951-52; 1952-53 & 1953-54) and Forest Hill (2017-18; 2018-19 & 2019-20) are the only clubs to win three successive premierships
- ✚ Surrey Hills lost three successive grand finals from 1924-25 to 1926-27
- ✚ From 1944-45 to 1954-55, all eleven premierships were shared between Mitcham (5) & East Burwood (6)
- ✚ From 1957-58 to 1966-67, nine premierships were shared between Nunawading (5) & Blackburn (4) with only Bulleen (1963-64) breaking the sequence
- ✚ Boroondara (1892-93), Mitcham District, Blackburn South and Vermont South are the only clubs to finish runners-up, but not win a premiership.
- ✚ East Burwood-Bennettswood also finished runners-up, however both East Burwood and Bennettswood won premierships as separate clubs before their merger
- ✚ From 1995-96 to 2005-06, East Box Hill played in six grand finals for two premierships.
- ✚ Forest Hill was awarded the 2019-20 premiership after the second day was abandoned when Cricket Australia and in turn Cricket Victoria banned cricket immediately owing to the impending impact of the COVID-19 Coronavirus across the entire country.
- ✚ Both the 2020-21 and 2021-22 grand final were played as one-day games after the season started in November due to COVID-19 restrictions. All fourteen home and away games were played as one-dayers.
- ✚ Vermont finished runners-up six times from 2011-12 to 2023-24.
- ✚ This list includes premierships won during WWI and WWII. Although Shields were 'retired' during these years, BHRDCA Heritage is of the view that the standard of matches and players continuing during these years justifies inclusion on any premiership list

Total 'Saturday' premierships

The definition of Saturday premierships includes open-age two day and one day grades (introduced in 2005-06) that are played almost exclusively on Saturday's. This list excludes Veterans, Twenty20, Mid-Week, Twilight, Under 18's and Junior competitions.

The following clubs have won twelve or more premierships during their affiliation with the BHRDCA.

Titles	Club
45	Nunawading (inc 1 as Tunstall)
43	Heatherdale ¹ (inc 1 as Parkview) Mitcham ¹ (inc 1 as Old Mitcham) Blackburn
40	Vermont
37	Box Hill North Super Kings (inc 17 as Box Hill North and 7 as St. Peters)
31	Forest Hill ¹
30	East Burwood ¹ (inc 11 as East Burwood-Bennettswood)
29	East Box Hill (inc 4 as Box Hill Adelphians)
28	Koonung Heights ¹
27	Eley Park (inc 4 as E-Bees)
26	Vermont South ¹ Bulleen Templestowe Burwood District (inc 2 as Burwood Socials);
25	Templestowe
23	Blackburn South ¹ (inc 10 as Blackburn South High School)
19	Blackburn North (inc 2 as Meadow)
18	Yarraleen
17	Canterbury Doncaster ¹ (incl 11 as Doncaster Footballers)
16	Elgar Park (inc 13 as Box Hill Church of Christ)
14	St. David's ¹ Park Orchards ¹ (inc 2 as Donvale District)
13	Deakin (inc 4 as Surrey Park and 1 as Parks)
12	East Doncaster; Glen Waverley Hawks; Kerrimuir United

¹Includes tied/shared premierships

Notes:-

2024-25 Premierships

- ❖ Blackburn and Blackburn South won two premierships each

All pre-merger premierships are listed against the original club

- ✚ Box Hill North Super Kings premierships include those won by St. Peter's before 1968. BHRDCA Life Member: Angus Falla confirmed that when the Box Hill North junior cricket players joined St. Peter's, the senior club decided to adopt the name of the suburb instead of the church.
- ✚ Blackburn and Nunawading have met in 14 grand finals, with Blackburn winning nine.
- ✚ Mitcham won three premierships in 1950-51 (A, B and D). Blackburn also won three in 1961-62 (A, C and D)
- ✚ Doncaster Footballers won three successive McIntosh Shield 2nd premierships from 1976-77 to 1978-79.
- ✚ St. Davids won A Grade in 1976-77, A1 Grade in 1977-78 and McIntosh Shield in 1979-80.
- ✚ Heatherdale won four premierships (A1, A2, C1, C2) in 1980-81
- ✚ Bulleen Templestowe won A1, A2 and A3 premierships in 1982-83; Bennettswood repeated this feat in 1984-85.
- ✚ Until 2014-15, Yarraleen won 14 premierships and had never lost a senior grand final, until they lost three in 2015-16 but won two from two in 2016-17. From 1988-89 to 1990-91, their first XI won three successive premierships. Yarraleen has played in 23 Grand Finals for 18 Premierships
- ✚ Box Hill North Super Kings won four premierships (McIntosh Shield, Dorothy McIntosh Shield, B, D) in 2022-23
- ✚ Nunawading has played in 90 Grand Finals; Mitcham 87; Blackburn 84; and Heatherdale 80
- ✚ St. Davids has finished Runners-Up 31 times from 45 Grand Finals
- ✚ The following premierships were shared / tied
 - 1903-04 A Grade Box Hill and Old Mitcham
 - 1970-71 A2 Grade Heatherdale and Doncaster Footballers
 - 1985-86 McIntosh Shield 3rd Mitcham and Forest Hill
 - 1985-86 A1 Grade Vermont South and Blackburn South High School
 - 2015-16 H Grade Syndal and Manningham
 - 2018-19 Dorothy McIntosh Shield Park Orchards and St. David's
 - 2022-23 Howard Wilson Shield Mitcham and Koonung Heights
 - 2024-25 D Grade East Burwood and Forest Hill

Twenty20 Premierships

The Twenty20 competition was introduced with two grades in 2010-11. The competition had grown to eight grades by 2024-25

The following table shows all clubs that have won more than four premierships.

Titles	Club
7	Heatherdale
6	Yarraleen
5	Blackburn North; Box Hill North Super Kings; Forest Hill; and Vermont
4	Park Orchards and Templestowe

Veterans Over 40's Premierships

This includes all Veteran premierships played for since 1997-98. This list excludes BHRDCA Legends (Over 50) as these are counted in VCV premierships.

There have been 107 premierships awarded in BHRDCA Veterans cricket. Of these, BHRDCA Heritage is missing the details of two premierships.

The following table shows all clubs that have won more than four premierships.

Titles	Club
11	Mont Albert
7	Surrey Hills
6	Mitcham
5	Vermont
4	Mazenod OC; Lower Eltham

Junior Premierships

This includes all Junior premierships played for since 1948-49. This list includes Under 18's which was introduced in 2007-08. NOTE: Under 10 'Anklbyters', Fast Nines and Super Sevens are not awarded premierships along with the Under 12C grade from 2016-17

The following table shows all clubs that have won more than ten premierships.

Titles	Club
50	Heatherdale ¹ (inc 2 Shared premierships)
44	Blackburn
29	Nunawading ¹
27	Bulleen Templestowe ¹
23	Box Hill North Super Kings; Eley Park
22	Vermont South; Vermont
20	Burwood District; Forest Hill
19	East Burwood ¹ (incl 8 as East Burwood Bennettswood)
18	Mitcham
16	East Box Hill; St. David's
14	Glen Waverley Hawks ¹
13	Laburnum
12	Doncaster (ex Doncaster Footballers); Blackburn South; East Doncaster; Kerrimuir Utd
10	Templestowe

Notes:-

¹Includes tied/shared premierships.

Age Group details

- The Under 16 competition commenced in 1948-49 and was split into two sections from 1963-64.
- The Under 14 competition commenced in 1964-65.
- The Under 12 competition commenced in 1971-72.
- The Under 18 competition commenced in 2007-08.
- Alpha Gradings (A, B, C) were introduced in 1977-78.

Overall

-  Premierships won by combined teams from two different clubs are not included in individual club tallies.
-  Donvale, Eildon Park, Heathmont, St.Andrews, and Vermont South have all won two Under 18 premierships
-  Blackburn (21) has won the most Under 16 premierships, followed by Heatherdale (19), East Burwood (10), Nunawading (9), and Doncaster (7)
-  Heatherdale (21) has won the most Under 14 premierships, followed by Blackburn (13), Forest Hill (10), and Nunawading (10)
-  Bulleen Templestowe (17) have won the most Under 12 premierships, followed by Burwood District (13), Vermont South (12), Blackburn (10) and Vermont (10)
-  The Box Hill Technical School and Box Hill High School won three premierships each during the first dozen years of junior competition.